

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1996-09-16

1 dear b ahá'í f riends,
30 july 1996 enclosing the announcement to all the friends in Austria of the
31 goals you have adopted for the four year plan. The clarity with which you
32 have set them forth and your emphasis on the respective responsibilities of
33 the institutions, the communities and the individual believers should greatly
34 assist the friends in acquiring a vision of what is to be achieved, and their own part in
the work.
35 you may still find that some believers have difficulty in accurately com-
prehending the concept of entry by troops. it may help you, when you
36 encounter such problems, to stress the point made by the universal house
37 of justice in its various messages, namely that arriving at the point of entry
38 by troops, and then fostering it, is a process. it is the advancement of this
39 process that is the goal of the four year plan, and the exact steps to be taken
40 in each area will depend upon how far the process has already developed by now. An
essential element of the process is the preparation of the bahá'í
41 communities and individual believers and their training in the knowledge, not only
of how to prayerfully attract receptive souls and to bring entry by troops about but, equally
important, how to consolidate the gains so that it becomes an enduring development. No
doubt you have this aspect of the 235.3
236 1
236 2
237 m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e
238 55plan clearly in mind in the goal of establishing training institutes, which
239 you have assigned to your own Assembly, and in which the counselor and
240 Auxiliary board members will closely collaborate with you.
241 certainly, characteristics of bahá'í life such as a loving and understand-
242 ing relationship between the individual believers and their Assemblies; a
243 warm, welcoming and harmonious atmosphere in bahá'í communities;

244 and individuals who uphold bahá'í standards in their everyday lives, are in
245 themselves vital strengths in the advancement of the process. Such characteristics
can help the friends, not only to attract others to the cause, but
246 also to manifest understanding, patience and encouragement in relation to
247 the new believers.
248 The house of justice was also very pleased to see that you have the aim
249 of raising up National Spiritual Assemblies in the federal republic of yu-
250 goslavia, macedonia and bosnia. This is a major task, and the universal
251 house of justice will pray for divine assistance to surround all who devote
252 themselves to its achievement in such very difficult circumstances.

indeed, the house of justice will pray in the holy Shrines that the

253 friends throughout Austria will unitedly arise for the achievement of all the
254 goals you have set before them in the four year plan, and thus attract the
255 confirmations of b ahá'u'lláh on their strenuous labors.
256 with loving b ahá'í greetings,

for Department of tHe secretariat

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Acquisition of Apartment in Paris, France

Where 'Abdu'l-Bahá Stayed

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]